

Dasher Swims On:

Deep in the ocean there are millions of colorful fish, wandering crabs, and mysterious creatures of all kinds. Schools of brave fish patrol the salty waters to make sure all the sea animals are alive and well. In one school of fish there swam a very smart little striper named Dasher. He was always doing his best to keep up with his school. He knew to look out for danger and always swam in the right direction. One day, the leader of the school asked Dasher to deliver a message to the King of the Sea. He gave Dasher a sealed envelope and told him, "Swim quickly, and do not stop for ANYTHING!" Dasher felt honored to be chosen for this special mission, and he swam off as fast as he could. As Dasher swam through the beautiful coral reef, three yellow angelfish called to him and asked him to stop and play. "No, I cannot delay, friends." Dasher replied. "I must deliver this message to the King!" A short while later, a huge puffer fish asked him to stop and have a bite to eat. "No, kind friend, I cannot. I must not be distracted, for there is an important job that I do!" He told the puffer fish. At the edge of the wavy seaweed forest, a group of dark eels asked Dasher to go with them to see a show of sea horses. "That sounds like fun for sure, but I must stay focused on the task before me. The King is waiting for my arrival, and I must complete my mission!" Dasher swam all through the vast ocean and never once slowed down to visit with any of the other sea animals. When he finally arrived before the King, and handed over the sealed envelope, the King just smiled and winked at Dasher. "Congratulations young Dasher!!" The king exclaimed. "You have proven that you are ready to be the leader of your school. All through the ocean you kept your focus, and would not be distracted or kept from your job. From this day forward, you shall lead your school of fish, and all the sea creatures will look up to you!"